

Investment Case & Three-Year Financial Plan

Project Sitara — bottom-up model · conservative / base / aggressive cases · staged capital with hard gates

SUMMARY

The financial story on one slide

₹1.25 Cr

Initial ask (Scenario A)

₹4.55 Cr

12-month staged total (A+B)

M30

first EBITDA-positive month (base)

₹1.42 Cr

Year-1 revenue

₹6.34 Cr

Year-2 revenue

₹12.16 Cr

Year-3 revenue

+₹0.20 Cr

Year-3 EBITDA (2%)

₹7.85 Cr

peak staged funding

₹11,306

LTV vs CAC ₹3,600 (3.1x)

Churn

the #1 financial risk

Honesty note: this is a deliberately conservative bottom-up build. 3-yr cumulative EBITDA is -₹4.63 Cr; the business is a Year-4 profit story funded by ₹7.85 Cr of staged, gated capital. The aggressive case (₹22.6 Cr Y3 revenue, +₹6.3 Cr EBITDA) requires churn ≤4.5% — only claimable after cohorts prove it.

TAKEAWAY A staged ₹7.85 Cr buys a ₹14.8 Cr exit-ARR business at base — and caps every tranche's risk with a gate.

Revenue streams: core vs future

IN CORE MODEL

- Monthly subscriptions (40% of subs)
- Annual subscriptions (60%; cash collected upfront, revenue recognised monthly)
- Premium tiers (25% of subs; consult minutes included)
- Add-ons: extra consult minutes, premium reports (~8% attach)

FUTURE UPSIDE (not modelled)

- Family plans (priced per household)
- Ritual fulfilment commission (DharmaSetu module, 20–25% take)
- Matchmaking / kundli reports at wedding season
- B2B muhurat API (wedding platforms) · white-label

Pricing architecture — four plans, two markets

Plan	Customer	Monthly	Annual	Mix	Net eff. ₹/mo	Incl. human support
NRI Standard	NRI individual	\$12.99	\$99	45%	₹913	—
NRI Premium	NRI premium	\$24.99	\$199	12%	₹1,795	30 consult-min / quarter
India Aarambh	Metro India	₹499	₹3,999	30%	₹339	—
India Pragati	Metro India premium	₹999	₹7,999	13%	₹678	15 consult-min / quarter

₹880/mo

blended total ARPU (net) incl. add-ons

60%

annual billing share — cash ahead of revenue

79%

blended gross margin (model output)

TAKEAWAY Annual-first pricing hedges the churn risk and funds working capital.

ASSUMPTIONS

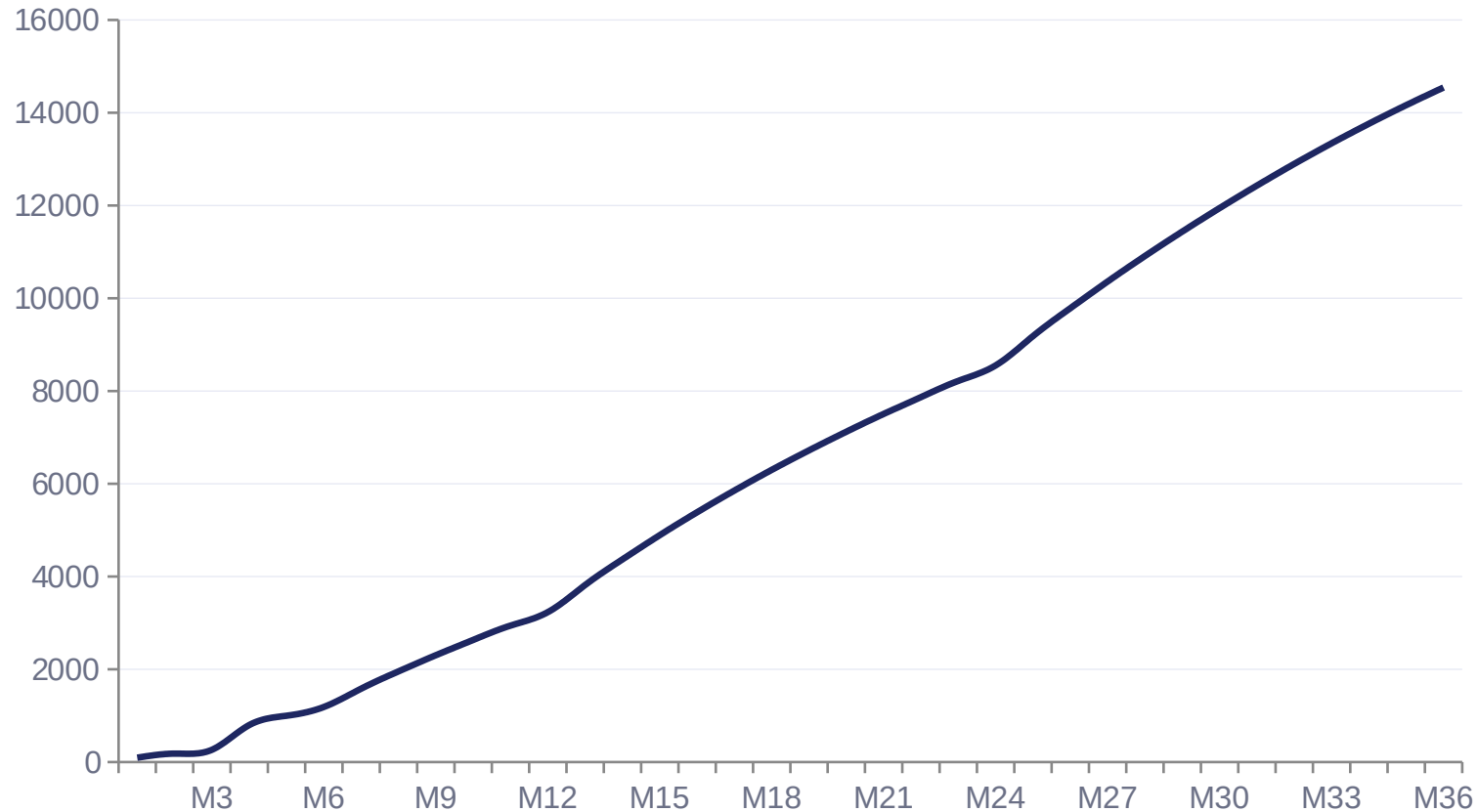
Core assumptions — with their sources

Assumption	Value	Type	Source / logic
Blended CAC	₹3,600	Benchmark+est.	AstroTalk domestic ₹575–870 (Entrackr); NRI premium 4–5x assumed
Monthly churn (base)	6.0%	Benchmark+est.	Recurly DTC 6.5%/mo; annual-mix damping; VALIDATION TARGET
Visitor→trial / trial→paid	3% / 25%	Estimate	Gate-1 replaces with cohort actuals
Referral share of new	12%	Estimate	Family-chart gifting loop
Refund rate	2.5%	Estimate	30-day money-back guarantee
AI + infra cost / user / mo	₹85	Estimate	LLM + ephemeris + cloud at Jul-2026 rates
Human minutes / user / mo	₹45	Estimate	Premium-tier allowance blended
Support + payment fees	₹25 + 2.8%	Fact/est.	Stripe/Razorpay published pricing
FX	₹90 / \$	Estimate	Sensitivity tested

TAKEAWAY Three assumptions decide everything — churn, ARPU, CAC — and Gate-1 measures all three.

GROWTH

Paying customers — 36-month build (base case)



3,231

month-12 payers

8,552

month-24 payers

14,544

month-36 payers

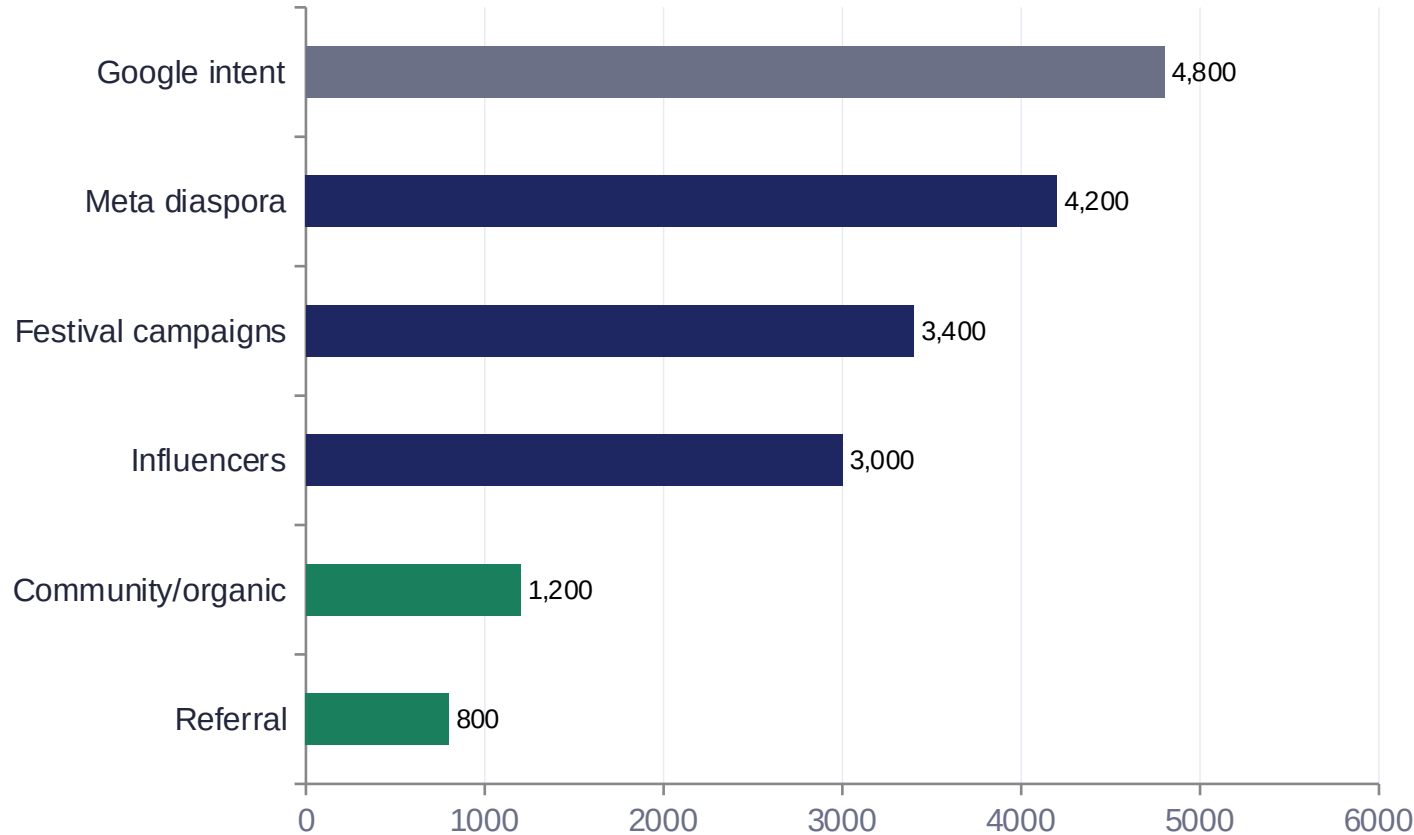
TAKEAWAY No hockey stick: growth is $\text{marketing-spend} \div \text{CAC}$, damped by churn, every month.

Acquisition funnel — representative month (M12)



TAKEAWAY Funnel ties to spend and CAC — no orphan conversion claims.

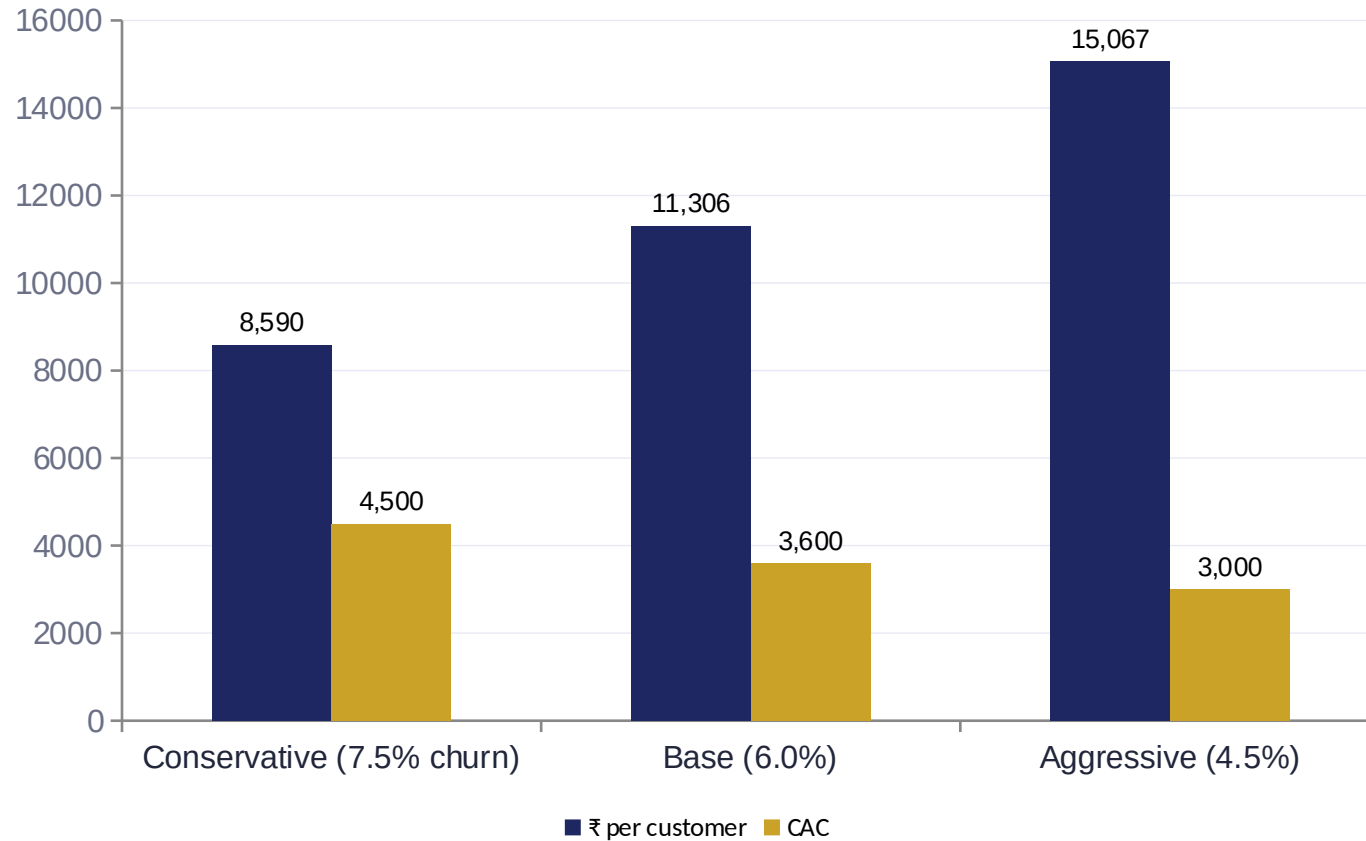
CAC by channel → blended ₹3,600



- Spend mix: Meta 40% · Google 15% · influencers 15% · community 12% · referral 10% · festivals 8%
- Blended ₹3,600 = weighted average (Marketing sheet)
- Referral loop: gifting a family chart costs ₹800 and deepens the moat
- Benchmark: AstroTalk recovers CAC in 6–8 months; our payback is 5.3 months at 3x their ARPU

TAKEAWAY Blended ₹3,600 with a payback of 5.3 months — conservative against the category benchmark.

LTV ₹11,306 · LTV:CAC 3.1x · payback 5.3 months



3.1x

LTV : CAC (base)

5.3 mo

CAC payback

16.7 mo

expected customer life

1.9x

conservative ratio — the floor that triggers stop-loss debate

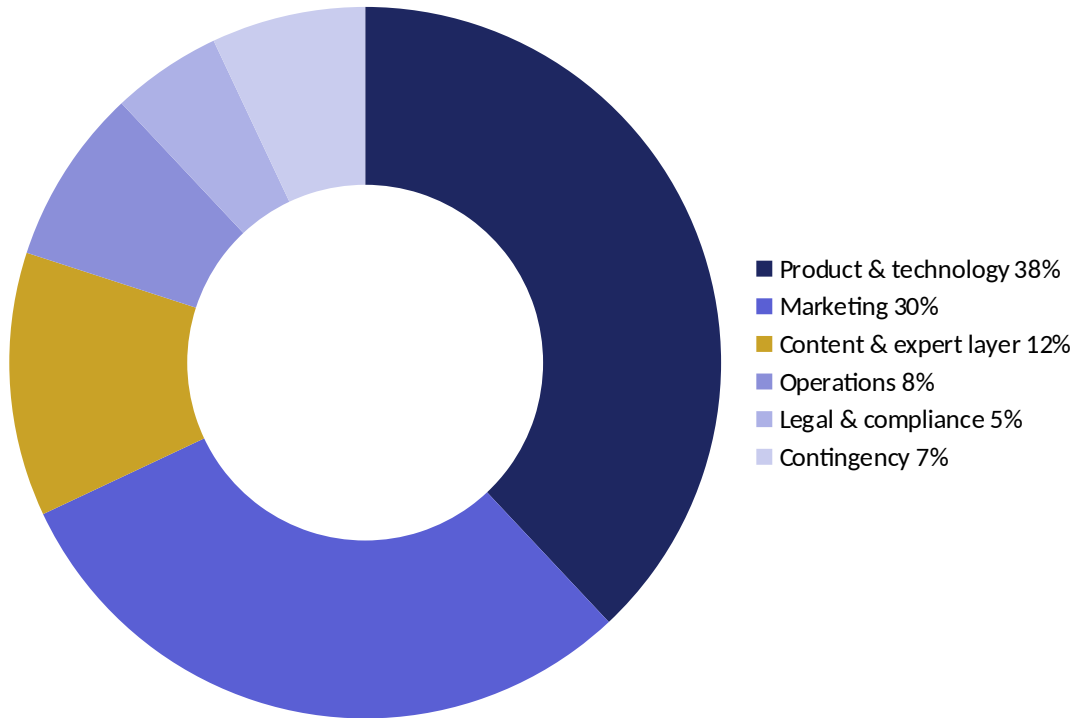
TAKEAWAY Unit economics clear the 3x bar without any upsell credit — and fail gracefully, visibly, if churn slips.

Where each ₹880 goes



TAKEAWAY 77% contribution margin/user before CAC — software economics with a human premium layer.

18-month allocation (Scenarios A + B = ₹4.55 Cr)



- Product & tech ₹1.73 Cr: 3 engineers, design, chart engine licence, AI usage, security, QA
- Marketing ₹1.37 Cr: brand, landing, paid cohorts, influencers, festival campaigns, referral incentives
- Expert layer ₹55L: Jyotish lead, corpus curation, astrologer panel contracts, ethics review
- Ops ₹36L: support, panel ops, QA-of-guidance workflows
- Legal ₹23L: DPDP/GDPR, T&Cs, ASCI counsel, IP, insurance
- Contingency ₹31L (7%) — unallocated by policy

TAKEAWAY Every rupee is mapped to a gate; marketing money unlocks only on validated cohorts.

Lean validation & build — ₹1.25 Cr

Item	Detail
Timeline	Months 1-6
Team	2 engineers + founder + part-time Jyotish lead + contract designer (~5.2 FTE)
Users targeted	50 concierge @ \$15/mo → 500 founding members @ \$99/yr
Expected revenue	~₹32L cash (founding annuals + concierge)
Success criteria	Concierge M2 renewal ≥60% · landing capture >25% · CAC <₹4,000 · activation >60%
Maximum acceptable loss	₹1.25 Cr (hard stop-loss)
Decision gate	Month-6 board review → Gate 2

TAKEAWAY ₹1.25 Cr buys the three numbers that decide everything: churn, CAC, activation.

Focused market launch — +₹3.3 Cr (months 7–18)

Item	Detail
Investment	₹3.3 Cr tranche at M7 (cumulative ₹4.55 Cr)
Hiring	Team to ~9 FTE: +1 engineer, growth, content, panel ops, support
Marketing budget	₹8L/mo (M4–6) → ₹15L/mo (M7–12) → ₹25L/mo (Y2)
Customers	3,231 by M12 • ~6,500 by M18
Revenue	₹1.42 Cr Y1; M18 run-rate ~₹55L/quarter GP
Gross margin	79% blended
Cash burn	Peak ~₹22L/mo; minimum cash ₹31L (policy floor ₹40L — tranche timing flagged)
Milestones (Gate 3)	Churn ≤6% • blended CAC ≤₹3,600 • NPS ≥55 • cohort audit

TAKEAWAY Launch capital follows evidence; every milestone is a number, not an adjective.

Accelerated scale — +₹3.3 Cr at PMF (months 19–36)

Item	Detail
Investment	₹3.3 Cr tranche at M19 (peak staged funding ₹7.85 Cr)
Marketing	₹35L/mo average through Y3
Expansion	India Pragati scale-up · matchmaking/kundli reports (wedding season) · rituals cross-sell module
Customers	8,552 by M24 → 14,544 by M36 (base)
Revenue / profit	Y3 revenue ₹12.16 Cr · EBITDA +₹0.20 Cr · exit ARR ≈ ₹14.8 Cr
Break-even	First EBITDA-positive month: M30 (base) · M23 (aggressive)
Return shape	Exit-ARR multiple on ₹7.85 Cr staged capital; Series-A optionality after M18 audit
Risks	CAC inflation at scale · incumbent response · aggressive case requires churn ≤4.5%

TAKEAWAY Scale is a consequence of gates passed — never a substitute for them.

Year 1 — monthly P&L (₹ lakh)

₹ lakh	Q1 (M1-3)	Q2 (M4-6)	Q3 (M7-9)	Q4 (M10-12)	Year 1
Net revenue	3.5	17.4	49.5	71.6	142.0
COGS	0.7	3.7	10.4	15.0	29.8
Gross profit	2.8	13.7	39.1	56.6	112.2
Salaries	32.7	32.7	57.3	57.3	180.0
Marketing	9.0	24.0	45.0	45.0	123.0
Tech + G&A + conting.	10.5	10.5	18.0	18.1	57.1
EBITDA	(49.4)	(53.5)	(81.2)	(63.8)	(260.0)*

*Sum differs from quarterly display due to rounding; exact figures in Excel. Founding-member annual cash (₹27L) arrives in Q2 ahead of recognition.

TAKEAWAY Year 1 is a purchased learning curve: ₹2.60 Cr of EBITDA investment buys 3,231 paying customers and proven cohorts.

Years 2 and 3 — annual P&L (₹ crore)

₹ crore	Year 2	Year 3
Net revenue	6.34	12.16
COGS	1.33	2.55
Gross profit	5.01	9.61
Gross margin	79%	79%
Salaries	2.32	4.10
Marketing	3.00	4.20
Tech + G&A + contingency	0.92	1.11
EBITDA	(2.23)	+0.20
EBITDA margin	(35%)	+2%
Net profit	(2.24)	+0.19

M30

first EBITDA-positive month

+₹19L

EBITDA in month 36 (run-rate ₹2.3 Cr/yr)

79%

durable gross margin

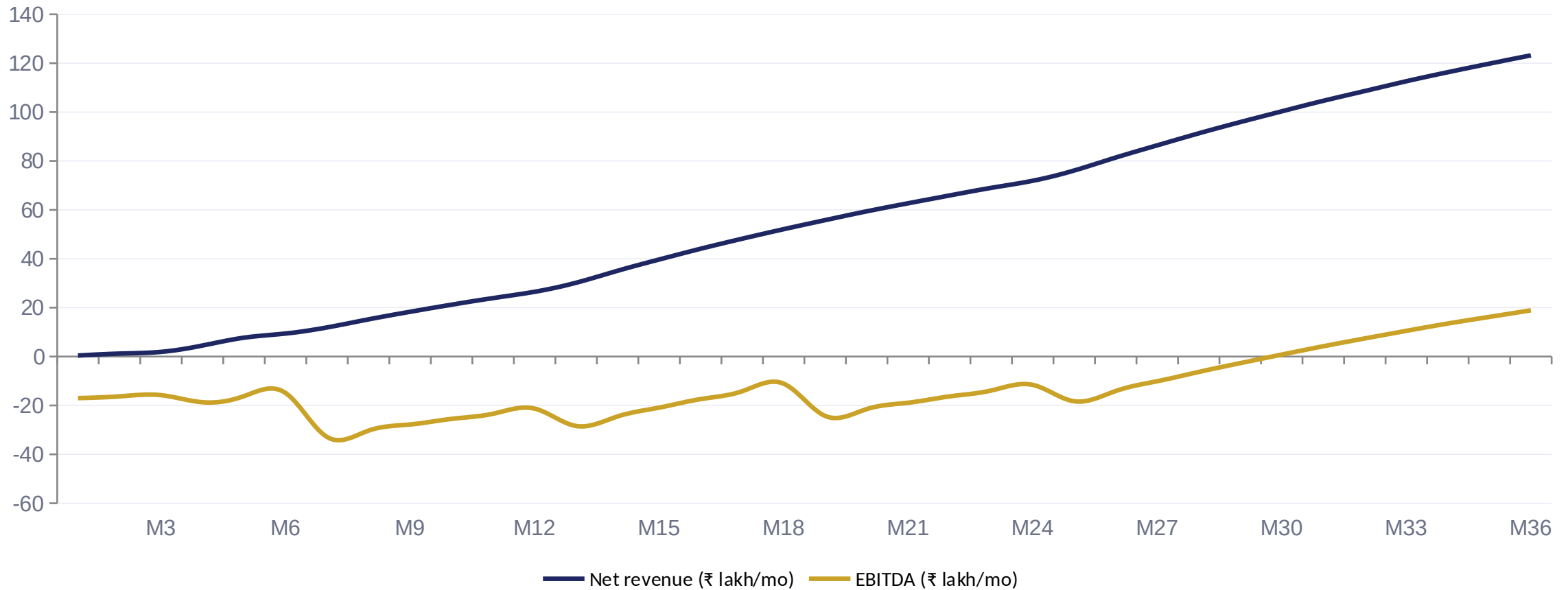
TAKEAWAY The P&L crosses over inside the plan window — on conservative assumptions.

Cash flow & funding plan

Item	Amount / timing
Tranche 1 — Scenario A	₹1.25 Cr at M1 (validation + build)
Tranche 2 — Scenario B	₹3.3 Cr at M7 (post Gate-1)
Tranche 3 — Scenario C	₹3.3 Cr at M19 (post cohort audit)
Peak staged funding	₹7.85 Cr
Minimum cash balance	₹31L (M6) — floor policy ₹40L, flagged; mitigated by founding-member cash
Deferred-revenue cushion	Annual plans collect ~5.5 months ahead of recognition
Closing cash M36	₹3.47 Cr (base) — funds Y4 without further capital
Additional funding requirement	None in base case within 36 months; conservative case triggers stop-loss instead

TAKEAWAY The board never has more than one gated tranche at risk at any time.

Revenue ramp and the EBITDA crossover



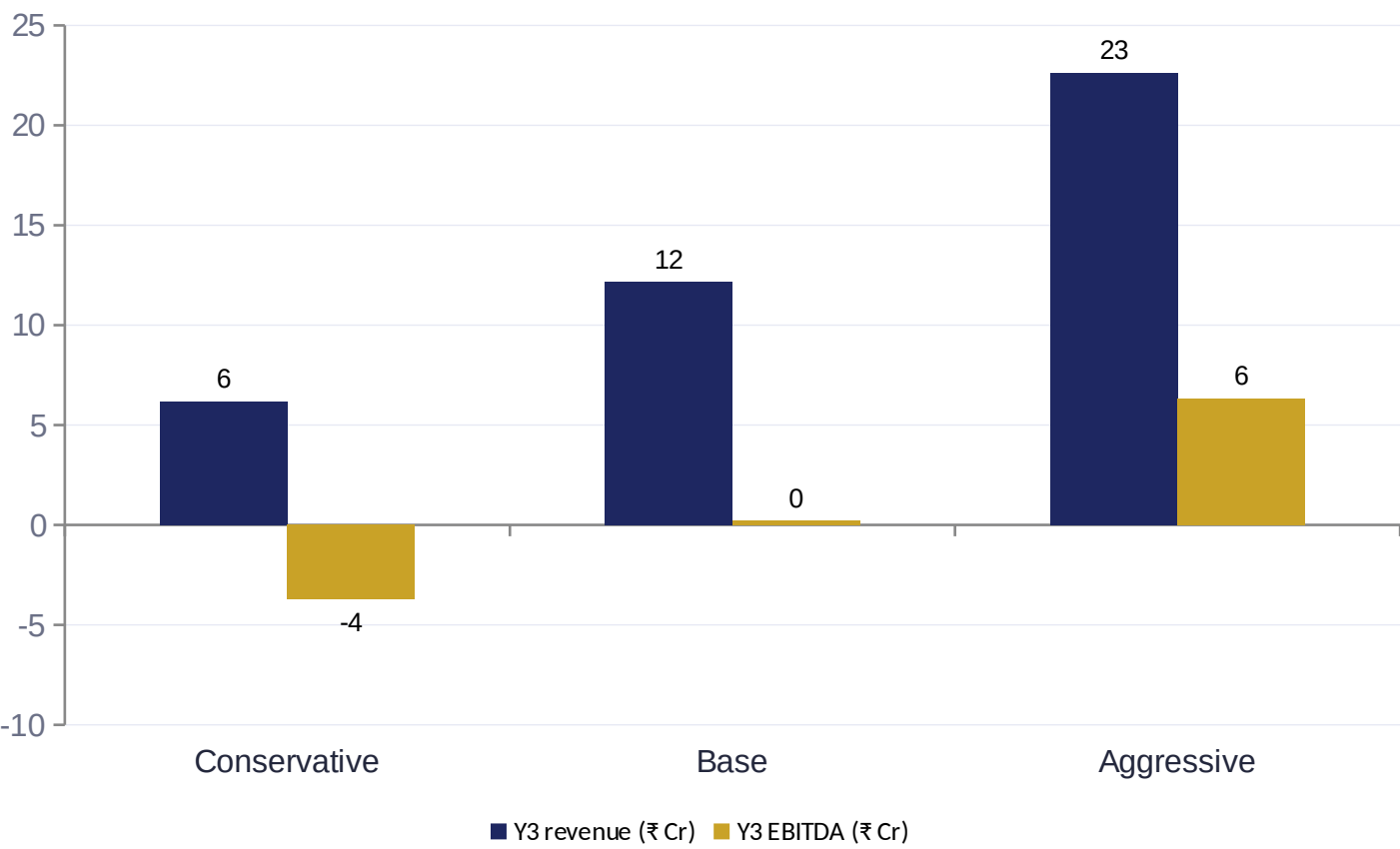
TAKEAWAY Steady compounding, visible crossover — no hockey stick anywhere in this deck.

What break-even requires — three cases

Metric	Conservative	Base	Aggressive
Monthly churn	7.5%	6.0%	4.5%
Contribution / customer / month	₹607	₹678	₹762
Fixed cost at crossover (₹/mo)	—	~₹52L	~₹48L
Customers to break even	not reached	~7,700	~6,300
Revenue to break even (₹/mo)	—	~₹68L	~₹55L
Break-even month	beyond M36	M30	M23
Cash consumed to BE	stop-loss at gates	~₹6.9 Cr	~₹4.6 Cr

TAKEAWAY Base case breaks even at ~7,700 customers — 0.05% of the diaspora-adult addressable base.

Conservative · base · aggressive



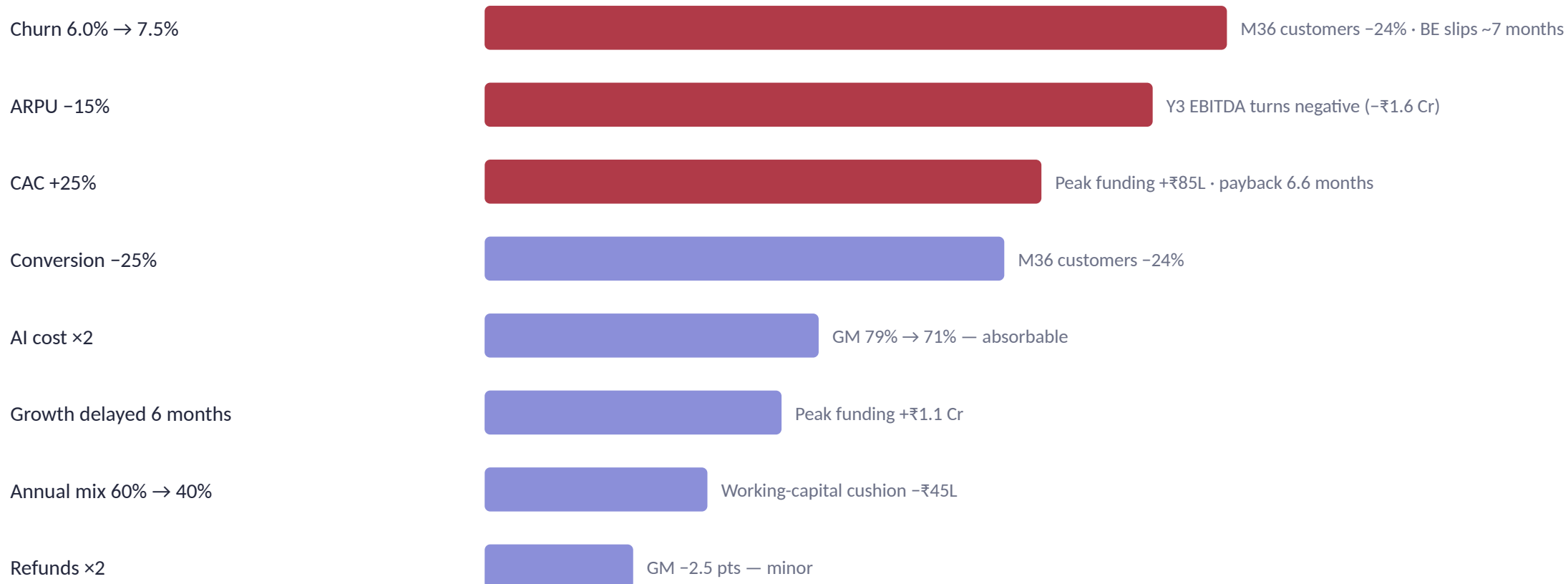
	Cons.	Base	Aggr.
M36 payers	7.5K	14.5K	24.3K
Exit ARR (₹Cr)	6.7	14.8	24.9
BE month	>36	30	23
Peak cash (₹Cr)	5.9*	7.85	8.6*

*Conservative peak reflects stop-loss at gates; aggressive adds growth capital only after cohort proof.

TAKEAWAY The spread between cases is exactly why capital is staged and gated.

SENSITIVITY

What moves the model most



TAKEAWAY Top-3 drivers: churn, ARPU, CAC — all three are measured by the ₹1.25 Cr validation before scale money moves.

What each investment level buys — and its constraint

Level	What it buys	Payers target	Exit ARR	3-yr cum EBITDA	Constraint
₹50L	Concierge validation only; no product	50 pilot + 250 founding	₹0.25 Cr	-₹0.5 Cr	No product = no compounding
₹1.25 Cr	Validation + v1 + founding 500 (Scenario A)	500-800	₹0.7-0.9 Cr	-₹1.1 Cr	Stops at Gate 1 by design
₹4.55 Cr	A + B: launch to ~6,500 payers (M18)	3,200 (M12)	₹3.4 Cr (M18)	-₹4.4 Cr	CAC inflation risk beyond ₹15L/mo spend
₹7.85 Cr	Full staged plan (base case)	14,544 (M36)	₹14.8 Cr	-₹4.6 Cr	Churn ≤6% required; gates unchanged
₹10+ Cr	Adds India mass-tier + rituals module earlier	18-22K	₹18-22 Cr	-₹4 to -₹5 Cr	Diminishing: retention gates bind, CAC rises

TAKEAWAY ₹7.85 Cr staged is the efficient frontier; more money buys speed, not certainty.

The same money in the other top ideas

Metric	Sitara	Sahay	KalaOS	DharmaSetu	Smriti
MVP investment	₹0.6–1.0 Cr	₹0.8–1.3 Cr	₹0.6–1.0 Cr	₹0.5–0.9 Cr	₹0.6–0.9 Cr
3-yr cash need	₹6–7 Cr	₹9–12 Cr	₹4–5 Cr	₹5–7 Cr	₹5.5–7.5 Cr
Gross margin	72–78%	40–65%	65–72%	55–70%	50–65%
Monthly churn	5–7.5%	2.5–4%+life events	2.5–3.5% logo	3–5%	3.5–5%+aging-out
Break-even	~M30	~M30–34	~M22–26	~M28–34	~M30–36
Y3 revenue	₹11–17 Cr	₹16–22 Cr	₹9–12 Cr	₹7–11 Cr	₹6–10 Cr
Y3 EBITDA	₹0.8–1.8 Cr	(₹1)–₹1.5 Cr	₹1.2–2.2 Cr	₹0.3–1.2 Cr	(₹0.5)–₹0.8 Cr
Risk-adj. score	8.1	8.0	7.6	7.4	7.1

TAKEAWAY The ranking survives financial scrutiny — not just strategic scoring.

DOWNSIDE

What the bad case looks like — and why we never fully ride it

- Conservative walk: churn 7.5%, CAC ₹4,500, ARPU -8% → M36 only 7,538 payers, Y3 EBITDA -₹3.74 Cr, no break-even in window
- Exposure ladder: Gate-1 failure caps loss at ₹1.25 Cr (≈₹95L net of founding cash); Gate-3 failure caps at ₹4.55 Cr with a ~₹3.4 Cr-ARR business and pivot assets
- Stop-loss triggers: concierge M2 <40% · founding <250 by M6 · churn >8% for 2 consecutive quarters · CAC >₹6,000 blended for 2 quarters
- Pivot assets even in failure: trust brand, astrologer panel, chart engine, cohort data — reusable for hybrid-credits model or KalaOS

STOP-INVESTMENT CONDITIONS

- Concierge M2 renewal <40%
- <250 founding members by month 6
- Churn >8%/mo, 2 consecutive quarters
- Blended CAC >₹6,000, 2 quarters
- Regulatory action on category claims

TAKEAWAY The downside is visible, bounded, and pre-agreed — the definition of a governable bet.

Risk register with mitigations

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation
Subscription conversion fails	Medium	High	Concierge gate before code; pivot to membership+credits pre-planned
Free-AI erosion	Medium	Medium	Moat = memory + deterministic engine + humans + ethics brand
Incumbent response (AstroTalk/AstroSage)	Medium	Medium	Premium NRI niche they cannot serve without cannibalising fear-revenue
Regulatory / claims (ASCI, CPA)	Low-Med	High	No outcome guarantees; ethics code; marketing counsel review
Key-person Jyotish credibility	Medium	Medium	Codify methodology into reviewed corpus from day 1
Emotional-dependency ethics	Low	High	Spending caps, vulnerable-moment detection, human referral prompts
FX and platform fees	Low	Low	Web-first billing; FX sensitivity tested

TAKEAWAY No hidden risks: each one is named, sized, and answered.

Reporting cadence and gate calendar

Monthly MIS

Payers · cohort retention curves · CAC by channel · NPS · cash runway

Quarterly review

Full P&L vs model · sensitivity re-run · risk register refresh

Gate 1 — Month 6

Concierge + founding results → approve/deny ₹3.3 Cr Tranche B

Gate 2 — Month 12

Churn $\leq 6\%$, CAC $\leq ₹3,600$, NPS ≥ 55 checkpoint

Gate 3 — Month 18

Independent cohort audit → approve/deny ₹3.3 Cr Tranche C

TAKEAWAY Cohort curves to the board, every month — the model stays falsifiable.

Four options before the board

1 · Do nothing

₹0

Category IPO window passes; the premium NRI niche gets claimed — likely by an incumbent's spin-off. Opportunity cost, not safety.

2 · Validate & build v1 ✓ RECOMMENDED

₹1.25 Cr

Capped risk; buys churn/CAC/activation truth in 6 months; every later rupee becomes evidence-based.

3 · Build & launch now

₹4.55 Cr

Skips the cheapest learning; commits launch capital on research alone; higher variance for no added upside.

4 · Partner / acquire

n/a

No suitable ethics-compatible target; white-label astrology stacks would inherit the trust problem we exist to solve.

TAKEAWAY Option 2 dominates: the same information at a fraction of the capital at risk.

THE ASK

Approve ₹1.25 crore — Scenario A

Item	Commitment
Use of funds	Product ₹52L · expert layer ₹18L · marketing ₹22L · ops+legal ₹17L · contingency ₹16L
90-day deliverables	Concierge cohort live · landing >25% capture · 20 interviews · chart-engine alpha
6-month target	500 founding members · concierge M2 renewal ≥60% · CAC <₹4,000
12-month target (post Gate-2)	3,231 payers · ₹1.42 Cr revenue · churn ≤6%
Stop-loss	Concierge M2 <40% or founding <250 by M6 → stop/pivot; exposure capped ₹1.25 Cr
Next funding decision	Month-6 board: Gate 2 (₹3.3 Cr) on cohort evidence
Board support required	Approval today · monthly MIS review · Gate-2 calendar commitment

Where every number lives

Document	Contents
Excel model (17 sheets)	Assumptions · Pricing · Customer Growth · Funnel · Revenue · COGS · Headcount · Marketing · OpEx · P&L · Cash Flow · Unit Economics · Scenarios · Sensitivity · Idea Comparison · Investment Returns · Dashboard
Research report (Edition 2)	14 categories · 20 scorecards · sources with URLs · rejected-idea evidence
Deck outlines	Slide-by-slide spec incl. presenter notes for both decks
Investment memo (1 page)	The ask, gates, stop-loss, returns
Idea comparison (1 page)	Top-10 side-by-side

TAKEAWAY Everything is traceable: deck → Excel cell → research citation.

**₹1.25 crore buys the answer
to a ₹1,182-crore question.**

Thank you. Discussion.